

6 Tech Beats Catheterisation Lab, 2002

The development of the indigenous cardiac catheterisation laboratory (Cath Lab) in 2002 to undertake a coronary angiogram and perform an angioplasty has cut back the cost of setting up such a facility as well as the fee that the patient pays for cardiac risk assessment and treatment. With continuous technological advancements, the Cath Lab is becoming more flexible and offering a variety of features not just for imaging the heart but also for other areas of the human body.

8 Fighting the Odds Response Modifier Therapy, 2003

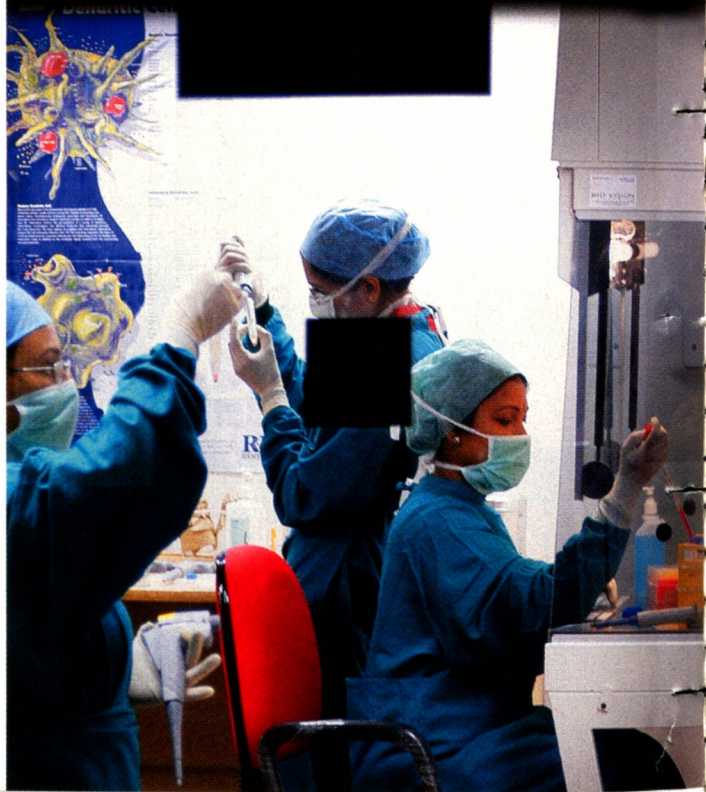
The therapy was introduced to boost or restore the ability of the immune system to fight cancer, infections and other diseases. It is also being used to lessen certain side-effects that may be caused by some cancer treatments. Agents used in the therapy include monoclonal antibodies, growth factor and vaccines.

7 Sustaining Life Coronary Bypass Surgery, 2002

A team of surgeons at the Wockhardt Hospital and Heart Institute, Bangalore, led by Vivek Jawali, performed the first minimal invasive coronary bypass surgery in 2002 without putting the patient under general anaesthesia or ventilator support. The 78-year-old patient, a smoker, had multiple complications including diabetes, renal problem and blockages in the carotid arteries supplying blood to the brain. His lungs were unable to tolerate general anaesthesia and the multiorgan dysfunction made him unfit for the heart lung machine.

9 Future Perfect Stem Cell Banking, 2004

Stem cell banking came of age in 2004 with the launch of the first family cord blood bank in India to usher in the revolutionary breakthrough of umbilical cord stem cell banking. LifeCell in Chennai was opened with a tie-up with Cryo-Cell International, USA, the world's biggest cord blood bank. The cells are banked for 21 years for a fee. "It doesn't present an ethical dilemma unlike the umbilical cord which has always been discarded as biomedical waste" (INDIA TODAY, June 2005).



BANDEEP SINGH

10 Call For Help Ambulance Service, 2004

The introduction of the well-equipped ambulance service in 2004 by the Emergency Management Research Institute, founded by B. Ramalinga Raju of Satyam Computers, is changing the paradigm in emergency care. Access to the unique service is through the common number 108 in 12 states. The public-private partnership model of ownership and management makes it a sustainable system that is poised to outstrip similar services abroad. "The service has 652 ambulances taking victims to 3,300 registered hospitals" (INDIA TODAY, November 2008).

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